### What is AEPC?

**Apparel Export Promotion Council** is the official Body of Apparel exporters.

It provides assistance to Indian exporters as well as importers / International buyers choosing India as their preferred sourcing destination for garments.

### 12.7.1 Types of Goods

#### Types of Merchandise Planning Process

- Staple/Basic Merchandise consists of items that are in continuous demand over an extended time period. Examples: salwars, kurtis
- Fashion Merchandise consists of items that are in demand for a relatively short period of time. New products are continually introduced into these categories, making the existing products obsolete. Examples: high-end women's apparel.
- A Fad is a merchandise category that generates a lot of sales for a relatively short time, often less than a season. Example : cowl collars, puff sleeve garments.

#### General Features of Staple Merchandise Categories

- Relatively easy to forecast demand and the consequences of making mistakes in forecasting are not great
- Predictability of demand makes it easy to plan for continuous replenishments
- Generating orders for inventory replacement can be automatic when the inventory falls below a pre-determined level

#### General Features of Fashion Merchandise Categories

- Forecasting of sales is much more complex
- Buyers for fashion category have much less flexibility in correcting forecasting errors.
- The attempt is to be as close to out of stock as possible at the same time that the SKUs become out of fashion
- Seasonal merchandise categories are treated more or less similar to the fashion merchandise and they consist of items whose sales fluctuate dramatically depending on the time of the year

## 12.8 Visual Merchandising



Figure 12.6 Store Display for Visual merchandising

Merchandise displays offer retailers non-personal ways of presenting products or information to consumers inside stores. It is common practice for wholesalers and sales representatives to set up and maintain displays of their products. This is one way that these suppliers can insure shelf space for their products, thus, they claim, benefitting both themselves and retailers. Retailers use displays to stimulate sales of products.

Visual Merchandising is the art of displaying merchandise in a manner that



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